Erasmus Mundus Application Preparation Package

CYBERSURE and SE4GD (plus a third-choice rule), 2027 intake

Version 1.0 DRAFT, 5 November 2026

1. Rules that apply to all Erasmus Mundus Joint Masters (E2: erasmus-plus.ec.europa.eu)

- Each consortium sets its own admission rules, deadline and selection. You apply **directly** to the consortium.
- Applications usually open October to January for a September start.
- You may apply to **at most 3** Erasmus Mundus Joint Masters per cycle (reported by secondary sources; confirm in each call).
- A person who has already held an Erasmus Mundus scholarship cannot receive another.

2. Programme comparison

	CYBERSURE	**SE4GD**
Field	Cybersecurity and Assurance	Software Engineering for the Green Deal (sustainability)
Consortium	NTNU (coordinator, Norway) with Aalto (FI), DTU (DK), plus Sweden, Estonia, Austria, France; double degree; **25 places**	LUT (FI), Univ. of L'Aquila (IT), VU Amsterdam (NL); triple degree
Degree requirement	CS/IT/informatics or related, ≥ 180 ECTS or ≥ 3 years ✅	⏳ unverified
GPA	Minimum GPA requirements exist (number not published). **Academic performance is screened first.**	⏳ unverified
English	**IELTS Academic 6.5 (Writing ≥ 6.0)**; TOEFL iBT 92/W22 (old scale) or 4.5 per section (new); Cambridge C1/C2. **No Duolingo English Test; Ethiopia not exempt.**	⏳ unverified
Application	Online; scholarships full and partial	**One single application** for programme and scholarship

	CYBERSURE	SE4GD
Self-funded cost (if no scholarship)	⏳	€9,000/year for Partner-Country students
2027 window	**16 Nov 2026 – 4 Jan 2027** (one page says 5 Jan; use 4 Jan)	⏳ expected Jan–Feb 2027 (unverified)
Fit with your profile	Security operations in fintech (IAM/MFA, WAF/WAAP, PAM/DAM ⏳ confirm); Computer Security (B)	Software and infrastructure engineering; efficient and reliable systems
Main risk	First academic screen at 2.62	Unknown requirements

Third choice: CYBERUS if it opens a 2027 scholarship call; otherwise **DEAI** (data engineering & AI; deadline 11 Jan 2027, E3). DEAI is maths-heavy, which is a weak point on your transcript. **Recommendation:** do not use a slot on DEAI unless it confirms 2.62 is acceptable.

3. Action 1 (this week): email both consortia before spending on IELTS

Draft email (you send it from your own address):

> Subject: Eligibility enquiry: 2027 applicant, BSc Computer Science (Ethiopia)
>
> Dear [CYBERSURE / SE4GD] admissions team,
>
> I intend to apply for the 2027 intake. I hold a BSc in Computer Science from Debre Tabor University, Ethiopia (2022, 240 credit hours over five academic years, taught in English). My cumulative GPA is 2.62 on a 4.00 scale, and my final-year semester averages were 3.05 and 3.35. Since graduating I have worked in fintech infrastructure and IT operations [⏳ years].
>
> Could you advise whether a cumulative GPA of 2.62/4.00 meets your minimum academic requirement, and whether final-year performance or professional experience is considered in the evaluation?
>
> Kind regards, [Passport name]

Decision rule:

- **"Eligible"** → book IELTS for the first half of December and prepare the application.
- **"Not eligible"** → drop the programme and save the test fee and effort.

4. CYBERSURE preparation timeline

Date	Task	Owner
by 12 Nov	Eligibility email sent	You
16 Nov	Read the 2027 call and checklist (copy into this file)	You + me

Date	Task	Owner
by 20 Nov	Book IELTS Academic (target 7.0, Writing ≥ 6.5 for a safety margin)	You
late Nov	Motivation letter draft 2 (requires resolved CV facts)	Me → you
early–mid Dec	Take IELTS (computer-delivered for faster results; turnaround in Ethiopia to confirm with the centre)	You
by 30 Dec	Upload documents; referees submit	You
by 2 Jan 2027	**Submit** (buffer before 4 Jan)	**You**

5. Motivation letter skeleton (CYBERSURE; tailored version after the facts are confirmed)

Structure (about 1 page; check the call for the limit):

1. **Opening, the problem you work on (≈ 80 words):** securing infrastructure that carries payments in Ethiopia. Concrete context: POS, QR and payment-gateway services delivered with partner banks.
2. **What you have done (≈ 150 words):** ⏳ confirmed security work, e.g. IAM/MFA administration, WAF/WAAP and PAM/DAM support at Kifiya (dates per HR), access controls and monitoring at SantimPay. One concrete example.
3. **Academic foundation and honest record (≈ 100 words):**
   - Computer Security (B), Distributed Systems (B−), Compiler Design (A−), Complexity Theory (A−)
   - CGPA 2.62 with final-year 3.05 / 3.35, stated plainly
   - Mathematics as a known weakness, and how you are addressing it
4. **Why CYBERSURE (≈ 150 words):** ⏳ name specific modules or tracks from the official curriculum. Why "assurance" (verification, risk, compliance) fits financial services. Why the mobility path (NTNU first year, then a second-year partner) suits you.
5. **Goal and return (≈ 80 words):** security engineering for Ethiopian and African fintech and banks. Concrete, modest, five-year goal.

What not to write:

- "Passionate since childhood"
- "Excelled academically"
- Tools you cannot discuss
- Any generic paragraph copied from the 2024 Italy letter

6. SE4GD notes (pending its 2027 call)

- **Angle:** software that uses computing resources efficiently. Your infrastructure work (capacity, virtualization, monitoring) relates to the energy and resource efficiency of IT systems. Claim only what you have done.
- **Preparation:** follow the same eligibility email, then motivation-letter flow, once se4gd.eu publishes the call.

7. Document checklist (common to Erasmus Mundus Joint Masters; confirm each call)

- ☐ Passport copy
- ☐ Degree certificate and full transcript (certified copy or scan, per call)
- ☐ CV (Europass is often accepted for Erasmus Mundus; check each call)
- ☐ Motivation letter (programme-specific)
- ☐ English certificate (IELTS/TOEFL; **no Duolingo English Test** for CYBERSURE)
- ☐ 2 reference letters (submitted by referees)
- ☐ Proof of residence (the Erasmus Mundus scholarship category depends on residence; CYBERSURE publishes a residency certification document)